

The Three Licences and How You Get One

Texas Occupations Code Chapter 1102 · 22 TAC Chapter 535, Subchapter R · For the TREC state exam (25 questions, pass at 75%)

This is the other half of your 25 state questions. Where the Standards of Practice tell you *how* to inspect, the Law tells you *who* may inspect, under whose supervision, and what happens when the rules are broken. Start with the three licences — almost everything else hangs off them.

The three licence levels

- **Apprentice Inspector** — the entry licence. Must be **sponsored** by a Professional Inspector and works under **direct supervision**. May not inspect alone.
- **Real Estate Inspector** — may perform an inspection for a buyer or seller, but must be sponsored and works under **indirect supervision** of a Professional Inspector.
- **Professional Inspector** — the only level that works **independently**. Needs no sponsor, and may sponsor and supervise the other two. **This is the licence you are sitting for.**

The most examinable distinction in the module: Apprentice = direct supervision. Real Estate Inspector = indirect supervision. Professional = none. If a question describes someone inspecting on their own, it is a Professional Inspector.

Who may sponsor

- A Professional Inspector is **not automatically** eligible to sponsor. They must have submitted at least **200 inspections** and received **written notice from TREC** that they are eligible to sponsor.

Becoming a Professional Inspector — the standard path

1. Hold an active **Real Estate Inspector** licence.
2. **12 months** of active experience as a licensed Real Estate Inspector, within the **preceding 24 months**.
3. **175 real estate inspections** completed under **indirect supervision**.
4. The qualifying education modules listed below.
5. Pass the **two-part examination**.
6. **Fingerprints** on file with the Texas Department of Public Safety.
7. Proof of **professional liability insurance, \$100,000 per occurrence** — required before the licence will issue.

You have **one year from the date the application is filed** to satisfy every requirement.

The qualifying education modules

- **40 hours** — Property and Building Inspection Module I
- **40 hours** — Property and Building Inspection Module II
- **10 hours** — Business Operations and Professional Responsibility
- **20 hours** — **Texas Law Module** (the subject of these four files)

- **24 hours — Texas Standards of Practice Module** (your Texas SOP files)

That is **134 hours** on the standard path. Anyone substituting for the inspector experience adds **20 hours** of Analysis of Findings and Reporting and a **40-hour Texas Practicum — 194 hours** in total — and may offer **3 years of personal experience** in a field directly related to home inspection, supported by **two affidavits**, in place of the inspector experience.

The examination

- Two parts: a **national** portion and a **state** portion.
- The national portion may be taken once Modules I and II, Business Operations and Analysis of Findings are complete.
- The state portion may be taken once Texas Law, Texas Standards of Practice and the Practicum are complete.
- **Fail three times** and you must take additional education before retaking.

Since the March 2021 rule change you may sit the **national portion before the state portion** — they no longer have to be taken together.

Check Yourself

An inspector is working alone at a property with no other licence holder present. Which licence must they hold?

Professional Inspector — the only level that may work without supervision.

How many inspections, over how long, on the standard path to Professional Inspector?

175 inspections under indirect supervision, with at least 12 months of active Real Estate Inspector experience in the preceding 24 months.

A Professional Inspector wants to take on an apprentice. What must they have first?

At least 200 submitted inspections and written notice from TREC that they are eligible to sponsor.

Verified against trec.texas.gov and the Texas Administrative Code on 22 August 2026. TREC rules change — re-check any figure before your exam date at trec.texas.gov/rules-and-laws.